How Much of the Picture Do You Have Before Mom Leaves the Hospital?

Twelve quick questions about what you know. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure Mom, and nothing here says what care she needs, where she should go, or what is covered.

1. Can you say, in a few sentences, why Mom went into the hospital and what has changed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you have her current diagnoses and her medication list in writing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which everyday activities Mom does on her own right now and which she gets help with: bathing, dressing, eating, using the toilet, getting out of bed, walking?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Has anyone on the care team told you what they've noticed about her memory, or about how she manages when no one is with her?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Has the care team told you what care they expect Mom to need after she leaves?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Has anyone told you where that care could be provided?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you been given an expected discharge date by the staff, and not only second-hand?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you have the discharge plan, or anything about it, in writing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you been told whether Medicare is covering Mom's care where she is now, and whether that is expected to change?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Has anyone gone over with you what your family may be asked to pay for, and from when?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Do you know which decision comes next, and who will be making it with you?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each question you still have, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not how Mom is doing, and it says nothing about what care she needs, what it costs or what is covered. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are one question to the right person away. Nothing here is medical, legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what you know and what's still open. The care interview asks the questions that fill those gaps, area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›